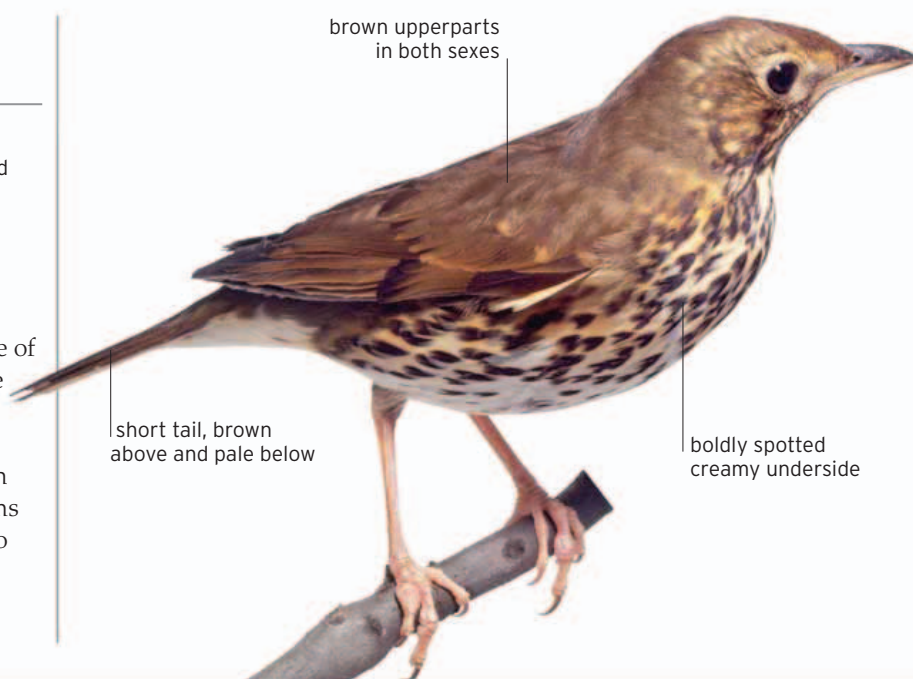


Blackbird

Turdus merula

- ↔ 10–12 in (25–30 cm)
- 📍 Europe, N. Africa, Asia; introduced in Australia, New Zealand, and South America
- ⊗ Common

The blackbird is a type of thrush instantly recognizable in the case of the male by its all-black plumage and contrasting yellow bill and eye-ring. The female is a well-camouflaged brown. Common in backyards, it feeds on earthworms and other small animals and also eats berries in fall. The male has a rich, musical song, usually performed from a high perch.



Song thrush

Turdus philomelos

- ↔ 8–10 in (20–25 cm)
- 📍 Europe, N. Africa, northwest Asia; introduced in Australia and New Zealand
- ⊗ Common

This small thrush is well-known for its habit of smashing the shells of garden snails on large stones and bricks, returning to the same stone time after time to build up a litter of shell fragments. The sexes look alike, but the male has a loud, inventive song made up of a variety of phrases, each repeated two to four times before moving on to the next.

Nightingale

Luscinia megarhynchos

- ↔ 7 in (18 cm)
- 📍 S. Europe, C. Africa, W. Asia
- ⊗ Common

Secretive and inconspicuous, with a habit of hiding in dense cover, this small, brown, russet-tailed bird reveals its presence with one of the most beautiful and varied of all bird songs. Often performed at night as well as by day, it is an arresting combination of slow, rich, fluting notes, throaty croaks and gurgles, and rapid trills and whistles. It nests in tangled thickets, often returning to the same site each year after spending the winter in Africa.

Northern wheatear

Oenanthe oenanthe

- ↔ 6 in (15 cm)
- 📍 N. North America, Asia, Central Africa
- ⊗ Common

One of the world's great migrants, the northern wheatear breeds in the far north—often on Arctic tundra—yet flies south to spend the winter in sub-Saharan Africa. While on migration, it stops off to feed in many regions in between. Elegant in black, white, and pinkish-buff plumage, and with a blue-gray back in the male, it feeds mainly on the ground, searching for insects and often perching on rocks or anthills with a bold, upright stance.



House sparrow

Passer domesticus

- ↔ 6 in (15 cm)
- 📍 Europe, C. and S. Asia
- ⊗ Common

The sociable, noisy house sparrow has been spread far beyond its original Eurasian range through its association with humans and now flourishes on every continent except Antarctica. Very adaptable, it feeds mainly on seeds, but often gathers to eat household scraps or crumbs from picnic sites. It naturally nests in tree holes and rock crevices, but takes readily to nest boxes and cavities in buildings. Both sexes have a brown back streaked with black.

Zebra finch

Taeniopygia guttata

- ↔ 4 in (10 cm)
- 📍 Australia
- ⊗ Common



Named for its barred black-and-white tail, this small, largely gray bird is the most common of Australia's grass finches—birds that typically live on open grasslands with scattered bushes and trees. It primarily feeds on plants and has a stout red bill that it uses to crack and remove the husks of small seeds, but it also eats insects and even catches termites on the wing. It forages in lively, noisy flocks and breeds at any time of the year after periods of heavy rain that stimulate plant growth. Unlike most other birds, it drinks by sucking rather than scooping up water in its bill.

Chaffinch

Fringilla coelebs

- ↔ 6 in (15 cm)
- 📍 W. Europe and N. Africa
- ⊗ Common

Like that of many small songbirds, the breeding plumage of the male chaffinch is much brighter than the female's, with pink underparts, a blue-gray cap, chestnut back, green rump, and white bars on its mainly black wings. Breeding males sing loudly from perches to claim their territories. Chaffinches prey mainly on insects in summer, but feed in flocks on seeds in winter.